

Daily Need to Know

Monday, 28 September 2026 · Pre-market brief

Coverage window, capture method and edition notes are at the back, in section 16.

1 Market snapshot — the close, and where it is trading now

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
US CASH EQUITIES — FRIDAY 25 SEP SETTLE · ~50 HOURS OLD AT CAPTURE			
S&P 500	7,743.41	▲ +39.28 (+0.51%)	Range 7,693–7,752; closed at 85% of it. 0.9% below the 7,816.70 high. 78.6% of Hedgeye band 7546–7797.
Nasdaq Composite	27,068.72	▲ +129.34 (+0.48%)	0.8% off the 52-week high. 60.9% of band. First winning week in three.
Dow Jones	51,828.62	▲ +478.64 (+0.93%)	Led the day; closed at 91% of range and snapped a three-week losing streak. Still 5.3% below its high.
Russell 2000	2,837.55	▲ +1.98 (+0.07%)	Flat on a green tape, closed mid-range; only index down on the week. 7.6% off high; 31% of bearish band.
Philadelphia SOX	12,668.93	▲ +176.39 (+1.41%)	Best of the indices, but still 13.6% below its 52-week high of 14,655. Micron reports Wed.
INDEX FUTURES — FRIDAY SETTLE · GLOBEX REOPENED 06:00 GMT+8; THE 10-MINUTE-DELAYED FEED HAD NOT YET PRINTED THE NEW SESSION			
ES (Dec)	7,803.75	▲ +36.75 (+0.47%)	Basis to cash +60.3 — normal carry for a December contract, which confirms this is a settle, not a live print.
NQ (Dec)	30,889.25	▲ +122.50 (+0.40%)	Friday range 30,679–31,000. No reopen print captured.
YM (Dec)	52,163	▲ +446 (+0.86%)	Basis +334 to cash Dow; settle.
RTY (Dec)	2,859.3	▲ +2.5 (+0.09%)	Basis +21.7; settle.
TREASURY YIELDS — FRIDAY CLOSE			
US 10-year	5.167%	▼ -4.1bp	Traded 5.228% intraday (a 52-week high, highest since 2007) then fell back. 84.6% of band 4.93–5.21.
US 30-year	5.490%	▲ +0.1bp	The only tenor not to rally: intraday 5.532% was also a 52-week high. Curve steepened.
US 5-year	4.993%	▼ -7.3bp	Largest rally on the curve, alongside the 2-year.
US 2-year	4.860%	▼ -7.1bp	2s10s +30.7bp , from +27.7bp: a bull steepener.
13-week bill	4.178%	▼ -0.4bp	Anchored by the 3.75–4.00% funds rate after the 16 Sep hike.
COMMODITIES — ENERGY FUTURES AT FRIDAY SETTLE; SPOT METALS LIVE ~9 MINUTES INTO THE NEW SESSION			
WTI (Nov)	92.41	▼ -2.20 (-2.33%)	Settled on Iran-talks hopes; -7.9% on the week (roll-flattered). 22% of band. Weekend news cuts against the settle.
Brent (Nov)	104.32	▼ -2.28 (-2.14%)	Brent-WTI \$11.91 , widest since May. Keith's Brent stop is ~\$97.
Natural gas	3.196	▼ -0.101 (-3.06%)	Back inside a band that was raised 22¢ at the ceiling; 69.5%.
RBOB gasoline	3.1875	▼ -0.1455 (-4.37%)	Worst of the energy complex on the day; no outlet attributed the move.
Gold (spot, live)	4,272.56	▼ -11.99 (-0.28%)	Change is vs Friday's spot close, over ~9 minutes of trade. Comex Dec settled 4,321.20 (+0.54%); basis \$48.6 / 1.1% . 30.5% of band.
Silver (spot, live)	64.008	▼ -0.282 (-0.44%)	75% of an unchanged \$61–65 bearish band. Comex settled 64.80.
Copper (spot, live)	6.6457	▼ -0.0250 (-0.38%)	63% of band 6.40–6.79. Comex HG settled 6.766, which would misread as 94%.
DOLLAR, VOLATILITY, CRYPTO			
DXY (live)	101.034	▼ -0.215 (-0.21%)	FX reopened 05:00 GMT+8: ~69 minutes of trade. The change is mostly Friday's drift; 63% of band.
USD/JPY (live)	157.377	▲ +0.096 (+0.06%)	Range this morning 157.18–157.50: 32 pips — noise, not a move.
USD/KRW (live)	1,355.03	▼ -10.82 (-0.79%)	Weak mark: onshore Seoul shut Fri for Chuseok; -0.8% spans several sessions of offshore trade. See \$18.

VIX	14.88	▼ -0.80 (-5.10%)	Settled 0.67 above the floor of a bearish band (18.5%). MOVE index -8.2% to 96.0 .
Bitcoin (live)	84,371	▼ -51 (-0.06%)	The only row that traded all weekend. Weekend range ~\$83.8k-84.5k; ~4% below the week's high.

Colour key: ▲ green up, ▼ red down, ◆ amber flat. Captured 06:09:13-06:09:15 GMT+8 on TradingView; Yahoo was rate-limited and returned nothing. Cash index closes and point changes match Yahoo Finance's closing figures exactly, and AP's rounded percentages. WTI and Brent match the EnergyNow settlement report to the cent. The 10-year matches the published 5.17% close. Yield changes are in basis points against Friday's prior close. Percentages against Hedgeye bands use the series Hedgeye names (\$4).

TL;DR — Friday was a relief rally built on one assumption: that Washington and Tehran were edging towards reopening Hormuz. Oil fell 2.3%, the 10-year backed off a 2007 high, and the Dow snapped a three-week losing streak. **The weekend removed that assumption.** On Saturday Trump rejected Iran's seven-day Hormuz proposal. On Sunday he said he is "always thinking" about strikes, and Tehran said it is still waiting for a "definitive" answer. Hedgeye upgraded gold to neutral and raised its nat-gas ceiling. Keith covered more than half his shorts at the top of the yield range, but calls this "trading around" positions, not a change of view. The week's tests are PCE on Wednesday, Micron after the close the same day, and payrolls on Friday (consensus ~100k). The first live number that matters is **where crude reopens against Friday's \$92.41 settle.**

2 The big picture — what it means

- Friday priced a de-escalation that the weekend did not deliver.** AP's lead attributed the whole rally to "a cooldown in oil prices". WTI settled at \$92.41 (-2.3%) on expectations of a phased US-Iran deal. Within 24 hours, Trump said the Iranian proposal "would not be acceptable". Hormuz remains closed and the US blockade continues, and Qatar-mediated indirect talks may resume as early as today (Axios, citing regional sources). The equity gain was **+0.5%**. Oil's fall was four times larger, and it is the input that just reversed.
- The bond market blinked, not broke.** The 10-year printed **5.228%** intraday on Friday, the highest since 2007. It closed at 5.167%, 4.1bp lower, and the MOVE index fell 8% to 96. The 30-year did not join the rally and settled at 5.49%, so the curve bull-steepened: 2s10s widened from 27.7bp to **30.7bp**. Money funds and bills are anchored at 4.18% under a funds rate hiked to 3.75-4.00% on 16 September, with 16 of 18 FOMC participants pencilling in more. Relief at the front end is not a turn at the long end.
- Credit made new lows while equities rallied.** HYG, LQD and TLT all printed 52-week lows intraday Friday (77.67, 102.735, 78.83). XLU closed the day on its 52-week low. Equities closed near their highs on the same tape. Hedgeye's credit bands were moved down again, and none of the bearish-side bands was relaxed.
- Breadth is still the S&P's weak point.** The S&P is 0.9% from its high and the Nasdaq 0.8%, but the Russell 2000 is 7.6% below its high and was the only index down on the week. On Friday's show Keith said 65% of stocks fell in Thursday's near-flat S&P session. The rally is carried by megacap AI names: Microsoft +3.7% and Apple at a record.
- Macro is running hot and prices are rising faster than sentiment can absorb.** September flash PMIs showed the fastest private-sector expansion in more than five years, with input prices "soaring". Core capex orders rose **+1.6%** against +0.5% expected, and claims are 197k. Consumers are losing confidence all the same: UMich final September was **48.1**, below the starting level of all six recessions since 1978, and one-year inflation expectations are **4.6%**. That is Hedgeye's #Quad2 (growth and inflation both accelerating) in one set of prints.
- This week decides whether October brings a second hike.** August PCE lands Wednesday (headline ~3.6% y/y, core ~3.2% expected; July 3.7% / 3.3%). Payrolls follow Friday at ~100k consensus, after August's +162k against 53k expected. Invezz puts October hike odds at 71%. Another upside payroll surprise would leave the 10-year's 5.21% Hedgeye ceiling as the only resistance.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- Treasuries:** 2y 4.860% (-7.1bp), 5y 4.993% (-7.3bp), 10y 5.167% (-4.1bp), 30y 5.490% (+0.1bp). The 3m-10y spread is **+98.9bp**. Keith's stated target for the 2-year is 5.22%, with "no longer-term resistance" below it, and he expects the curve to flatten and possibly invert by early 2027. Friday's steepening runs against that call.
- Dollar:** DXY is 101.03 live, 63% of a bullish band, and 0.77 below the 101.80 52-week high. USD/JPY is 157.38, holding a 32-pip range this morning. EUR/USD is 1.1385, only 0.5% above its 52-week low of 1.1324.
- Crude:** the Brent-WTI spread is **\$11.91**, its widest since May. That is the geography of the Hormuz closure: Atlantic barrels are cheap and Gulf-linked barrels are dear. Mansfield puts Gulf Coast-to-Asia VLCC freight at ~\$50m, against \$16m before the war. Keith is long Brent (BNO) with a ~\$97 stop, and Brent settled \$7 above it.
- Products:** RBOB fell **-4.4%** to \$3.1875 on Friday, the heaviest fall in the complex. We found no outlet attributing the move, and diesel was -6.4% on the week (Mansfield). Houthi attacks on Saudi infrastructure are the upside risk to products.

- **Gold:** spot is \$4,272.56 live, −0.28% in the first minutes of trade. Hedgeye upgraded it to **neutral** from bearish and lifted the band \$18–33. Keith holds it "below minimum" and is waiting for bullish TRADE and TREND. Spot is 23.7% below its 52-week high of \$5,598.75.
- **Silver and copper:** silver is \$64.01, 47% below its \$121.65 high. Copper spot is \$6.6457, 2.5% below its high, and Comex settled at a \$0.12 premium to spot.
- **Nat gas:** \$3.196, −3.1%. Thursday's close broke the old ceiling, and Hedgeye raised that ceiling 22¢, the largest band move in the table.

4 Hedgeye — regime, risk ranges & the Quad path

SIGNAL	READING	SOURCE & TIME (GMT+8)
Regime	#Quad2 — Keith calls it "Crushing It". Growth, inflation and yields are all accelerating.	Early Look, Fri 25 Sep 19:44
Quad path	No explicit path notation seen. The US Monthly Quad Forecast sits in the Macro Week Summary Notes, which rendered as image or linked content and could not be extracted. Nothing here asserts that the path is unchanged.	Macro Week Summary, Sat 06:32
Rates	Dollar up, rates up. The inflation Nowcast is +27bp above last month's print. With yields at the top of the range, Keith covered 50–100bp of TLT/LQD/HYG shorts.	Early Look; Macro Show notes 22:42
Book	Covered more than half of his Real-Time Alert shorts and partly covered IWM, XLU and XLI. Added GTLB, BBY, Bitcoin, Ether and Block (XYZ). Exited Colombia. Still short India, Australia, Germany and Switzerland.	Macro Show notes (AI summary)
Changes	ETF Pro: +BUG long; −LVHI long; −JOET and −UFO shorts. Signal Strength: 58 stocks, one removed (name not in text).	ETF Pro 22:24; SSS 23:32

Risk Range™ Signals — Early Look "#Quad2 Crushing It!", Fri 25 Sep 07:44 ET (19:44 GMT+8), Keith McCullough

Hedgeye does not publish at weekends, so **this Friday set is the live risk-range set for today**. No newer set exists. Monday evening's Early Look (~19:30 GMT+8) supersedes it.

INSTRUMENT	RANGE	TREND	PRIOR (24 SEP)	Δ FLOOR / CEILING	WIDTH	WHERE IT STANDS NOW
UST 10-year yield	4.93–5.21	bullish	4.92–5.15	+0.01 / +0.06	0.23 → 0.28	5.167 — 84.6% . Thursday's 5.208 was 99%; the ceiling was raised to 5.21 and Friday's 5.228 high still broke it intraday.
High Yield (HYG)	77.75–78.73	bearish	77.89–78.76	−0.14 / −0.03	0.87 → 0.98	77.86 — 11.2% . Friday's 77.67 low was a 52-week low and pierced the new floor intraday.
Inv. Grade (LQD)	103.0–105.0	bearish	103.4–105.2	−0.4 / −0.2	1.8 → 2.0	103.21 — 10.5% . Back inside after Thursday's break; 102.735 intraday was another 52-week low.
S&P 500 (SPX)	7546–7797	bullish	7540–7769	+6 / +28	229 → 251	7,743.41 — 78.6% . 54 points below the ceiling.
Nasdaq Comp. (COMPQ)	26397–27500	bullish	26309–27425	+88 / +75	1,116 → 1,103	27,068.72 — 60.9% .
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2812–2894	bearish	2814–2900	−2 / −6	86 → 82	2,837.55 — 31.2% . Band lowered again.
Health Care (XLV)	166–172	bullish	164–172	+2 / 0	8 → 6	170.70 — 78.3% . Floor raised under the long.
Software (IGV)	103–110	bullish	102–110	+1 / 0	8 → 7	Not in the capture universe; position unknown.
Energy (XLE)	61.07–65.99	bullish	61.04–65.99	+0.03 / 0	4.95 → 4.92	62.04 — 19.7% , 97¢ above the floor after −0.9%.

Volatility (VIX)	14.21-17.84	bearish	14.20-18.25	+0.01 / -0.41	4.05 → 3.63	14.88 — 18.5% . Ceiling cut 41¢.
US Dollar (USD)	99.98-101.65	bullish	99.92-101.58	+0.06 / +0.07	1.66 → 1.67	101.034 live — 63.1% .
Crude, WTIC continuous	87.96-107.99	bullish	87.61-108.68	+0.35 / -0.69	21.07 → 20.03	92.41 on CL1! — 22.2% .
Nat gas continuous	2.89-3.33	bullish	2.83-3.11	+0.06 / +0.22	0.28 → 0.44	3.196 — 69.5% . Thursday's 3.297 was above the old ceiling; Hedgeye raised the ceiling to meet it.
Gold spot	4224-4383	neutral ▲	4206-4350 (bearish)	+18 / +33	144 → 159	SIGNAL UPGRADED bearish → neutral. 4,272.56 live on TVC:GOLD = 30.5%. Comex would misread 61%.
Copper spot	6.40-6.79	bullish	6.33-6.79	+0.07 / 0	0.46 → 0.39	6.6457 live on OANDA spot — 63.0% .
Silver spot	61-65	bearish	61-65	0 / 0	4 unchanged	64.0085 live — 75.2% .

Prior bands come from the Thu 24 Sep Early Look ("Nobody Wants the Paper", Matthew Cooper), as reproduced in Friday's archived edition. Hedgeye's category feed does not paginate, so it could not be re-read there. Positions use Friday closes for cash, ETFs and futures, and live prints for spot metals and DXY. Spot gold, silver and copper are measured on TVC/OANDA spot; crude and gas on the continuous contract. The bands were published before Friday's session, and 10-year and HYG both pierced theirs intraday before closing back inside.

Band moves in one line. One signal changed: **gold was upgraded to neutral from bearish**, one day after it was downgraded, and its band rose \$18 at the floor and \$33 at the ceiling. The nat-gas ceiling rose 22¢ to meet the price. The S&P ceiling rose 28 points after being cut 26 the day before. The 10-year ceiling rose again, to 5.21. The credit, Russell and VIX bands were all moved lower. Again, nothing on the bearish side was relaxed.

What Keith actually said

- Early Look, Fri 25 Sep 07:44 ET / 19:44 GMT+8: "Yesterday we reached the stage of this Cycle's #Quad2 that I'm officially calling "Crushing It."" He defined it as "USA's PMI print for SEP went vertical into #Quad2" and "Hedgeye's Nowcast for US Inflation is +27bps vs. last month's "hawkish" print".
- Same note, on AI: "Bubbles are bullish when they're going up." On financials: "GS, MS, BAC - all on our Signal Strength Shorts list."
- Same note, on Meta: the switch from Short to Long "is the most recent major Single Stock example of what crushing it actually looks like."
- Macro Show, Fri 25 Sep (summary posted 10:42 ET / 22:42 GMT+8). The summary is AI-generated and carries Hedgeye's own error caveat, so it is reported here without quotation marks. Keith covered shorts because yields reached the top of the range and said this does not reverse the rates thesis. He plans to sell on green, because the one-month versus three-month volatility relationship is near a tipping point. Brent's trade stop is ~\$97. Gold stays below minimum until TRADE and TREND turn bullish.

5 Mag7 scoreboard

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
Nvidia	225.07	▲ +0.49 (+0.22%)	\$5.42trn	Flat into a weekend report that China may let Alibaba and ByteDance buy the RTX Pro 5500 (The Information). Largest company at \$5.42trn ; 4.8% off high.
Apple	341.07	▲ +5.15 (+1.53%)	\$4.98trn	Record close with no single catalyst; iPhone 18 Pro wait times stretched from 7 to 23 days (JPMorgan). 1.2% off the intraday high.
Alphabet	343.92	▲ +1.56 (+0.46%)	\$4.19trn	Lagging: still 15.8% below its 52-week high.
Microsoft	516.17	▲ +18.24 (+3.66%)	\$3.83trn	The day's driver: +3.66% on the Copilot agent overhaul, on volume 15% above average. Keith has it near the top of his buy list.
Amazon	249.67	▲ +0.29 (+0.12%)	\$2.69trn	Inert. 13.1% off high.
Meta	751.66	▼ -25.93 (-3.33%)	\$1.91trn	-3.33% after The Information reported a Muse agent vulnerability; still up ~30% in a month. Hedgeye remains bullish.
Tesla	372.11	▼ -5.83 (-1.54%)	\$1.47trn	BNP Paribas cut its target to \$268. 25.4% below the high and down ~26% YTD.

Friday closes. Caps are TradingView's market_cap_basic. Combined Mag7 capitalisation is ~\$24.5trn. Nvidia is the largest at \$5.42trn and Apple second at \$4.98trn.

6 Positioning & options

- **VIX 14.88** sits 0.67 above the floor of a bearish-TREND band, and the band ceiling was cut 41¢. The volatility market is pricing a quiet week into PCE and payrolls.
- **MOVE 96.0 (-8.2%)** is still far above the ~75 threshold Hedgeye treats as benign for bonds. Rates volatility is the one that is elevated.
- **Gamma:** Keith said on Friday that dealer gamma is back positive, which damps intraday swings. He also flagged the one-month versus three-month vol ratio as close to flipping systematic flows negative. That is his view and unverified here.
- **Crypto ETF flows:** spot Bitcoin ETFs took **\$2.39bn** of net inflows from 21 to 25 September, including ~\$999m on Monday 21st, the largest day of 2026. Bitcoin is up ~43.5% in Q3.
- **Short-covering risk:** Hedgeye covered heavily at the yield high. If PCE is hot, the cover-and-reload playbook points to shorts being re-added in credit, the Russell and utilities.

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

SECTOR	CLOSE	DAY	VS 52W HIGH	NOTE
XLI	170.43 ▲ +1.60 (+0.95%)		-9.4%	Top on the day — and on Hedgeye's short list, partly covered Friday.
XLK	196.27 ▲ +1.56 (+0.80%)		-1.2%	Microsoft and chips; 1.2% off the high.
XLF	54.84 ▲ +0.31 (+0.57%)		-6.4%	Recovered; GS, MS and BAC are Hedgeye Signal Strength shorts.
XLV	170.70 ▲ +0.83 (+0.49%)		-3.3%	Hedgeye long; 78% of band.
XLP	82.06 ▲ +0.36 (+0.44%)		-9.0%	Defensive bid, still 9% off high.
XLU	39.51 ▲ +0.15 (+0.38%)		-17.3%	Friday low of 39.125 was the 52-week low . The rate-sensitive shorts still lead the downside.
XLB	49.80 ▲ +0.12 (+0.24%)		-8.1%	Mosaic -4.1% weighed.
XLY	110.56 ▲ +0.24 (+0.22%)		-11.6%	Tesla and Nike (BofA downgrade) drag; 11.6% off high.
XLRE	41.56 ▼ -0.09 (-0.22%)		-10.5%	Mortgage rates at 7.49%, +30bp on the week.
XLE	62.04 ▼ -0.56 (-0.89%)		-6.2%	Oil -2.3%; 20% of its bullish band.
XLC	112.96 ▼ -1.03 (-0.90%)		-6.2%	Meta -3.3% took it last.

- **Leaders:** Industrials (+0.95%) and Tech (+0.80%). Industrials was a short-covering bid in a Hedgeye short. Tech was Microsoft plus the chip complex: SOXX +1.2%, AMAT +2.3%, SanDisk +1.4%.
- **Laggards:** Communications (-0.90%) on Meta and Energy (-0.89%) on crude. Those were the two single-cause moves of the day.
- **Rotation:** no defensive rotation. Utilities rose 0.4% but closed on a 52-week low, and staples rose 0.4%. Rate-sensitives still trail the tape by 9-17% from their highs, while tech is 1.2% from its high. As long as the 10-year holds above 5%, that gap keeps widening.

8 Forward — futures & the week ahead

Overnight tape. Globex reopened at 06:00 GMT+8, nine minutes before capture. TradingView's futures feed runs on a ten-minute delay, so **no reopen print was captured**, and the Friday-settle-to-reopen gap is the number to check first on screen. On the weekend news flow, crude is exposed to the upside and equity futures to the downside. That is an inference, not an observation. Bitcoin, the only instrument that traded through the weekend, held a ~\$700 range, so there is no risk-off signal from crypto.

DAY (GMT+8)	KEY EVENTS
Mon 28	China industrial profits; BoJ minutes; Dallas Fed manufacturing (22:30). Fed speakers Bowman and Barkin; Lagarde. Qatar-mediated US-Iran talks may resume (Axios). Hurricane Polo landfall in Baja California Sur.
Tue 29	RBA 12:30: all four major banks forecast a hike from 4.35% to 4.60%, and markets price ~90%. US JOLTS (~7.3m) and Conference Board confidence 22:00. Fed speakers Williams, Waller, Goolsbee. Carnival Q3.
Wed 30	China NBS/S&P PMIs 09:30, the last print before Golden Week (August manufacturing 49.8). Australia CPI. EZ flash CPIs. US PCE (Aug), Q2 GDP third estimate and BEA annual revision 20:30. ADP; Chicago PMI. Quarter-end.
Thu 1 Oct	Micron Q4 FY26 (~04:00 GMT+8, after Wed's close): guided \$50bn ±\$1bn and EPS \$31 ±\$1, against consensus of ~\$50.8bn and \$31.43. Japan Tankan 07:50 (large manufacturers forecast +26). Korea September exports (date unconfirmed). Mainland China shuts for Golden Week. ISM manufacturing 22:00 (August 54.6). Claims.

Fri 2 Oct **Nike Q1 FY27 04:15 GMT+8** (Thu 1:15pm PT, confirmed). **US payrolls 20:30**: ~100k consensus, unemployment 4.2%. Tokyo CPI; EZ flash HICP.

Accenture and McCormick (Wed) are on Newsquawk's list but not confirmed against company calendars. The next FOMC is 27-28 October on the Fed's published 2026 calendar. ISM services is expected the following Monday (unconfirmed). RBI meets 5-7 October.

9 Corporate news

- **Microsoft (+3.66%, \$516.17)**: relaunched Copilot combining chat, code generation and always-on agents, and closed at its highest level of the year. Nadella: "Trust is going to be the biggest issue for us" (Yahoo Finance).
- **Meta (-3.33%)**: The Information reported a Muse agent vulnerability. A malicious link plus user approval could expose cloud-hosted emails and files. Meta rated it SEV-2, then downgraded it to SEV-3. The stock is still near a one-month gain of ~30%.
- **Akamai (+15.3%)**: an **\$11.6bn**, seven-year compute deal with Anthropic, Akamai's largest ever and expandable by ~\$9bn. Anthropic receives warrants for up to 5% of Akamai at \$111.33. Akamai plans ~\$5.5bn of capex.
- **Oracle (-1.75%, \$137.10)**: fell for a second day after Bloomberg reported force majeure on its Project Jupiter data centre in New Mexico, citing power delays. About \$18bn of Jupiter-linked debt trades at stressed levels. The stock is **57.5%** below its 52-week high.
- **Intel (-3.45%, \$123.00)**: no single catalyst. The fall is profit-taking after a ~223% YTD run, following -3.1% on Wednesday.
- **Tesla (-1.54%)**: BNP Paribas cut its target to \$268, despite plans to ramp the Semi to 50,000 trucks a year. **Nike** was downgraded to Underperform at BofA ahead of Thursday's results; it is -43% YTD.
- **People Inc (+10.3%)**: the WSJ reported that MGM Resorts is discussing a bid for People, reversing People's earlier approach for MGM. **Twilio -4.4%** on an HSBC downgrade to Reduce; **Zscaler -4.0%**; **Mosaic -4.1%**.
- **After-hours**: quiet. Postmarket moves across the capture universe were within $\pm 0.5\%$, and Meta's -0.51% was the largest.

10 Macro data

- **UMich sentiment, final September: 48.1** against 47.5 consensus (August 51.7). Expectations 46.3; current conditions 50.9. **One-year inflation expectations 4.6%** (August 4.0%); five-to-ten-year 3.4% (3.3%). Yahoo called 48.1 a miss against 47.5, which is arithmetically wrong. The print beat the consensus we saw.
- **Durable goods, August: 0.0% m/m** against -0.3%. Ex-transport +0.3%. **Core capex orders +1.6%** against +0.5%.
- **Initial claims, week to 19 September: 197k** against 201k. Four-week average 202,250; continuing claims 1.719m (+2k).
- **September flash PMIs (23 Sep)**: the fastest US private-sector expansion in more than five years, with prices "soaring" (Axios). Yardeni cites flash manufacturing at **57.0**. The composite and services prints were not found.
- **Mortgage rates**: the 30-year fixed is **7.49%**, +30bp on the week (Yahoo), and follows the 10-year directly.

11 Geopolitics

- ▼ **Iran — deal rejected**. On Saturday Trump rejected Tehran's seven-day Hormuz proposal: "that deal would not be acceptable" (RFE/RL, NPR, CNN). On Sunday he told Axios he expects more talks this week: "They want to make a deal, but it is not the deal that I want to make". Asked about strikes: "I am always thinking about it." He also claimed more than 22m barrels transited Hormuz on Friday night under US escort. That is his claim and has not been verified.
- ◆ **Iran — Tehran's position**. Foreign Minister Araghchi said Iran awaits a "definitive" US answer via mediators and set three conditions: an end to attacks, unfrozen assets and permission to sell oil (The National). US Ambassador Waltz said Iran wants sanctions relief up front and has breached the ceasefire. Both are the parties' own claims.
- ▼ **Aviation sanctions**. Treasury Secretary Bessent announced coordinated pressure that has suspended up to 90% of Iran's foreign flights, including a cut-off from a UAE airport, and threatened secondary sanctions.
- ▼ **UK — RAF Fairford**. Counter-terror police arrested five men near the base, which US forces use for the Iran campaign, on suspicion of explosives and terror offences. Homes nearby were evacuated (NPR, CNN, TIME).
- ◆ **US-China**. The summit extended the trade truce two months, to 10 January 2027, and left tariffs, farm purchases, rare earths and tech curbs unresolved. A US-China AI safety summit is planned for Shenzhen in November. Separately, The Information reported that China may let Alibaba and ByteDance buy Nvidia's RTX Pro 5500. Hong Kong fell to a two-month low on the "no breakthrough" read.
- ◆ **US funding**. A continuing resolution funds the government to 11 December (NPR), so there is no 30 September shutdown risk. We did not independently confirm the signature.

12 Overnight setup — what Asia opens into

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE	STATE AT 06:09 GMT+8
ES	7,803.75	▲ +36.75 (+0.47%)	Friday settle; volume 1.57m. Reopen not yet visible.
NQ	30,889.25	▲ +122.50 (+0.40%)	Friday settle; volume 534,590.
YM	52,163	▲ +446 (+0.86%)	Friday settle; volume 75,068.
RTY	2,859.3	▲ +2.5 (+0.09%)	Friday settle; volume 171,653.
USD/JPY	157.377	▲ +0.096 (+0.06%)	Live, 69 min of session; 32-pip range.
USD/KRW	1,355.03	▼ -10.82 (-0.79%)	Live offshore; carries the Chuseok gap — weak mark.
USD/TWD	31.7196	▼ -0.1257 (-0.39%)	Live offshore; Taiwan also shut Friday — same caveat.
USD/CNH	6.7210	▲ +0.0019 (+0.03%)	Live; 16-pip range. Mainland shuts Thu 1 Oct for Golden Week.
EUR/USD	1.1385	▼ -0.0005 (-0.04%)	Live; 12-pip range.
Gold spot	4,272.56	▼ -11.99 (-0.28%)	Live, ~9 min of session.
Silver spot	64.008	▼ -0.282 (-0.44%)	Live, ~9 min.
Copper spot	6.6457	▼ -0.0250 (-0.38%)	Live, thin (230 lots).
WTI	92.41	▼ -2.20 (-2.33%)	Friday settle.
Brent	104.32	▼ -2.28 (-2.14%)	Friday settle.
Bitcoin	84,371	▼ -51 (-0.06%)	Live; genuinely continuous.
Ether	2,674.55	▼ -21.17 (-0.79%)	Live; 44% below its 52-week high.

Futures, WTI and Brent are Friday settles, ~49 hours old. FX has ~69 minutes of trade and spot metals ~9 minutes, so treat their changes as mostly Friday's drift, not this morning's information.

- **Previous Asian closes (Fri 25 Sep):** Nikkei **66,363.98 (+1.30%)**, helped by chips and dividend-date positioning. Hang Seng **24,510.10 (-1.01%)**, a two-month low. ASX 200 8,665 (-0.43%). **Mainland China, Korea and Taiwan were shut** for Mid-Autumn and Chuseok, so KOSPI 7,080.93 and Shanghai 3,888.37 are older closes. Seoul reopens after Chuseok; check for a substitute holiday.
- **What the US tape hands over:** semis (SOX +1.4%, AMAT +2.3%, Micron on Wednesday) and megacap software. That favours Tokyo Electron and Advantest in Japan and SK Hynix and Samsung in Korea. Korea's September exports for the first 20 days were +78% y/y, with chips +259%.
- **What Korea and Taiwan have to reprice:** two sessions of global moves they missed, including Friday's oil drop and the weekend's Iran reversal. USD/KRW at 1,355 is already 0.8% stronger for the won offshore.
- **Risk:** India and Australia are Hedgeye shorts on energy exposure. The RBA hikes tomorrow on ~90% pricing. China has three sessions before Golden Week, and Hong Kong is at a two-month low.
- **The single instrument most likely to move: Brent.** It settled at \$104.32 on a truce premise that Trump rejected within 24 hours. Every Asian energy importer, and the won and rupee, reprices off its reopen.

13 AI watch

- **Agents are now a security problem.** Microsoft is shipping always-on agents in the same week The Information reported a data-exposure flaw in Meta's Muse agent. Nadella's line: "Trust is going to be the biggest issue for us". Earlier in the week, Muse's launch hit banks, insurers, travel and brokers (Bloomberg, CNBC).
- **Anthropic-Akamai, \$11.6bn:** compute capacity is moving to edge and CPU-heavy networks, beyond the hyperscalers.
- **China:** DeepSeek passed \$1bn ARR after raising API prices 2.3–4.5x and plans a \$7.5bn Shanghai raise (The Information). Alibaba cut Qwen voice prices by up to 95%. MiniMax released M3.1-Flash-Preview.
- **Scale of the build:** Brookings projects the US AI buildout at **\$10.3trn**, ~3.6% of GDP a year for 2025–32. Axios reports data-centre borrowing is crowding the bond market, which links AI directly to 5% yields. Oracle's Jupiter force majeure is the first large site stalled by power.
- **Regulation:** New York City Council is weighing a 10-bill package with kill switches, 24-hour incident reporting and \$25k fines. Sanders and Casar introduced a bill to ban "superintelligence".
- **Micron (Wednesday)** is this week's AI-hardware test. Its guide calls for revenue of ~\$50bn a quarter, and the stock is 13.8% below its 52-week high of \$1,255.

14 Beyond the markets

- **Sentiment below every recession start since 1978.** UMich at 48.1 sits below the level at which all six recessions since 1978 began (CNN), while PMIs run at a five-year high. A gap this wide between surveys and hard data does not usually close by itself.
- **Iran's grounded airline network.** Bessent said he is "not sure how Iranian officials will get home from the UN". The aviation cut-off is a new sanctions lever, and it hits the UAE hub directly.
- **Hurricane Polo**, reported at up to Category 3, is expected to make landfall in Baja California Sur today. AM Best flags business-interruption exposure for insured infrastructure.
- **Freight:** a Gulf Coast-to-Asia VLCC now costs ~\$50m, against \$16m before the war (Mansfield). That cost is part of the \$11.91 Brent-WTI spread.

15 Appendix — stock cards

MSFT · MICROSOFT

\$516.17 ▲ +3.66%

Cap \$3.83trn · 6.8% off 52w high 553.72 · Hedgeye: near top of buy list · Next: agent rollout

Copilot agent relaunch moved it on volume 15% above average and to a 2026 closing high. This is the cleanest AI-software winner on the tape.

META · META PLATFORMS

\$751.66 ▼ -3.33%

Cap \$1.91trn · 3.6% off high · After-hours -0.51% · Hedgeye: bullish (switched from short)

The Muse security flaw is the reason, but the stock is up ~30% in a month. A SEV-3 rating is a speed bump unless a second report follows.

MU · MICRON

\$1,082.28 ▲ +0.16%

Cap \$1.22trn · 13.8% off high 1,255 · Reports Wed 30 Sep after close (Thu ~04:00 GMT+8)

Guided \$50bn ±\$1bn and EPS \$31 ±\$1; the street is at \$50.8bn and \$31.43. The memory cycle sets up Hynix and Samsung for Thursday's Asia session.

ORCL · ORACLE

\$137.10 ▼ -1.75%

Cap \$0.41trn · 57.5% below 52w high 322.54 · Jupiter force majeure

Power, not demand, is the constraint. About \$18bn of site-linked debt trades at stressed levels, which makes this a credit story now as well as an equity one.

INTC · INTEL

\$123.00 ▼ -3.45%

Cap \$0.65trn · 13.6% off high 142.35 · ~+223% YTD

Its second fall of more than 3% in three sessions with no catalyst. That is profit-taking in 2026's biggest megacap winner.

AAPL · APPLE

\$341.07 ▲ +1.53%

Cap \$4.98trn · record close; 1.2% below intraday high 345.34

iPhone 18 Pro wait times are 23 days, up from 7. A record without a headline is a demand story.

NKE · NIKE

— ◆ not captured

-43% YTD · BofA Underperform · Reports Thu 1 Oct 1:15pm PT (Fri 04:15 GMT+8)

The week's consumer test, arriving after a sentiment print of 48.1. Its price was not in the capture universe.

AKAM · AKAMAI

— ▲ +15.3%

\$11.6bn Anthropic deal · level not captured

The largest deal in Akamai's history comes with warrants that align the customer with the stock. On Friday the market re-rated it as AI infrastructure rather than a CDN.

16 About this edition

- **Covers:** the US session of Friday 25 September (settled), Friday after-hours, the weekend news flow of Saturday 26 to Sunday 27 September, and the first minutes of the new FX, metals and Globex week.
- **Captured:** 06:09:13-06:09:15 GMT+8 (2.3s) on TradingView, 96 of 96 instruments. Yahoo returned HTTP 429 and the circuit breaker aborted it, so cross-checks were recovered from wire copy (see §18).
- **Clock:** fired at 06:09 GMT+8, nine minutes after the Globex reopen. The futures feed is ten-minute delayed, so **every futures, energy and index-futures row is Friday's settle, ~49 hours old**. FX has ~69 minutes of trade, spot metals ~9 minutes, and crypto is continuous.
- **Settled vs live:** cash equities, Treasuries, futures and ETFs are settled (Friday). DXY, FX, spot metals, Bitcoin and Ether are live.
- **Hedgeye edition:** Full; the logged-in feed was reached. The live risk-range set is Friday's Early Look ("#Quad2 Crushing It!", Keith McCullough, 19:44 GMT+8 Fri), carried forward because Hedgeye does not publish at

weekends. Monday evening's Early Look supersedes it. Also read: the Macro Show summary, ETF Pro changes and the Signal Strength header.

- **Quad path:** no explicit path notation seen. The regime is #Quad2.
- **Not available:** the Macro Week Summary Notes body (the link rendered no text) and the Signal Strength list body.

17 Sources

Prices: TradingView scanner (bulk capture 06:09 GMT+8, 96 instruments). Yahoo Finance was attempted and throttled. Settle cross-checks: Yahoo Finance live blog (index closes), AP "How major US stock indexes fared" (25 Sep), EnergyNow crude settlements, Advisor Perspectives Treasury close.

Hedgeye: app.hedgeye.com, logged-in feed read ~06:12 GMT+8. Early Look 25 Sep and 24 Sep (the latter via the prior archived edition), Macro Show summary notes 25 Sep, ETF Pro Plus update and Signal Strength Stocks.

Macro: University of Michigan via Advisor Perspectives and CNN; Census durable goods via Zacks; DoL claims; Axios and Yardeni (PMIs, calendar); Newsquawk weekly; InvestingLive (RBA); FocusEconomics (China PMIs).

Narrative and single stocks: Yahoo Finance, TheStreet, Motley Fool, Stocktwits, The Information (via reports), Bloomberg (via reports), TechCrunch, WSJ (via Reuters and Bloomberg), 24/7 Wall St, Micron and Nike releases.

Commodities, geopolitics and AI: EnergyNow, Mansfield; RFE/RL, NPR, CNN, TIME, Axios, The National, US Treasury; Korea Times; Brookings, Fortune, The Decoder; UseTheBitcoin.

18 Data-confidence

CROSS-CHECKS PASSED

- **capture.py reconciliation: 0 matched ≤5bp · 0 minor · 0 divergent · 57 single-sourced.** Yahoo aborted after five consecutive 429s. **There are no divergent rows to resolve because no second machine source ran.** That is an absence of evidence, not a clean reconciliation.
- **Recovered by hand, index closes:** the S&P 7,743.41 (+39.28), Nasdaq 27,068.72 (+129.34), Dow 51,828.62 (+478.64) and Russell 2,837.55 (+1.98) match the Yahoo Finance closing figures to the cent. AP's rounded +0.5% / +0.9% / +0.5% agrees. Arithmetic check for the S&P: 7,743.41 – 39.28 = 7,704.13, which is Thursday's close as printed in Friday's edition. **Four of four match.**
- **Recovered by hand, energy:** WTI 92.41 (–2.20) and Brent 104.32 (–2.28) match the EnergyNow settlement to the cent. **Two of two match.** Gold Comex 4,321.20 (+0.54%) matches Yahoo's reported figure.
- **Rates:** the 10-year at 5.167% matches Advisor Perspectives (5.17%) and Invezz (5.17%).
- **Futures-cash basis is normal**, which confirms that the futures rows are settles: ES +60.3 against SPX (~0.78%, consistent with ~82 days of carry at a ~4% funds rate less dividends), YM +334, RTY +21.7. A live reopen print would have shown up as a dislocated basis.
- **Hedgeye band diff performed** against the Thu 24 Sep Early Look, reconstructed from the archived 25 Sep edition. All 16 instruments were diffed.

KNOWN CONFLICTS AND WEAK MARKS

- **2-year yield:** TradingView 4.860%, Advisor Perspectives 4.81%, Invezz 4.90% (intraday). The brief uses TradingView's 4.860% because it is the same feed as the rest of the curve. **2s10s is ±5bp uncertain**, and the steepening conclusion survives the range.
- **Brent:** AP and Yahoo said Brent "dropped below \$98", which conflicts with the \$104.32 settle (EnergyNow and the capture) and TheStreet's \$105.40 intraday. The \$98 line probably refers to another contract or an intraday print. It is not used.
- **UMich consensus:** Yahoo described 48.1 as "below 47.5 expectations", which is internally inconsistent. The brief reports a beat against 47.5 and has not confirmed that consensus independently.
- **USD/KRW and USD/TWD:** –0.79% and –0.39% span several offshore sessions, because the onshore markets were closed Friday. The USD/KRW range this morning (1,350.73–1,366.32) is too wide for 69 minutes of trade, so the row is carrying earlier sessions. **The level is usable; the change is not attributable to this morning.**
- **Gold:** spot-versus-Comex basis is \$48.6 (1.14%). On Comex, gold would read 61% of its band; on spot it reads 30.5%. The brief uses spot, as Hedgeye names. The same applies to copper: 63% on spot against ~94% on HG.
- **RBOB –4.4%** is TradingView-only; no outlet confirmed or explained it. The 52-week lows in HYG, LQD, TLT and XLU rest on single intraday low fields. The conclusion (new lows) is robust; the exact decimals are not.
- **Market-implied odds** (71% for an October hike, ~90% for an RBA hike) come from secondary outlets and were not checked against futures pricing.

KNOWN GAPS

- **No reopen print for futures, crude or Brent.** The Friday-settle-to-reopen gap, normally the most useful number in a Monday edition, was not captured because of the ten-minute feed delay.
- **Hedgeye:** the Quad path was not seen, because the Macro Week Summary Notes (Quad Forecast) rendered no extractable text. **Absence of a printed path is not evidence that the path is unchanged.** The Signal Strength list

body was empty in text, so the one removed name is unknown. MOMO Tracker, Crypto Quant and Chart of the Day did not appear in the Friday feed. They are the publications that would have carried position changes, and **absence of a Hedgeye position change is not evidence that there was none.**

- The IGV level was not in the capture universe, so its band position is unknown. Nike and Akamai closes were not captured.
- Not found: China September PMI consensus, the exact date of Korea's full-month exports, a confirmed CR signature, the flash PMI composite and services figures, and an explanation for the AMAT and INTC moves.
- No market-moving Russia-Ukraine development was found over the weekend. That reflects our search, not a guarantee.

TIMING & UNVERIFIED

- Capture window 06:09:13-06:09:15 GMT+8. The stalest rows are cash equities, closed since 04:00 GMT+8 Saturday: **~50 hours old**. Futures and energy settles are ~49 hours old. Treasury closes are ~50 hours old.
- Live rows: FX with ~69 minutes of trade, spot metals ~9 minutes, crypto continuous. **Any change figure on FX or metals is dominated by Friday's drift and should not be read as this morning's move.**
- Weekend Iran news is subsequent to every settle in this document and is not priced in any row except Bitcoin.
- Monday's Early Look (~19:30 GMT+8) supersedes all risk ranges here. The RBA decision on Tuesday 12:30 GMT+8 and US PCE on Wednesday 20:30 GMT+8 will reset rates and FX rows.
- **Verify live prices before acting.** This brief is information only and not investment advice.